

3- FortiGate WAN Configuration

Overview

This guide demonstrates how to configure a WAN interface on a FortiGate firewall, including the available addressing modes, administrative access, default gateway, and DNS settings.

Lab Environment

Firewall: FortiGate VM64

WAN Interface: port1

Related Video: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HysPfHox0LQ>

Step 1 - Navigate to Interfaces

Navigate to Network > Interfaces and edit the interface (port1).

Step 2 - Configure the WAN Interface

Available Addressing Modes:

- Manual – Configure the static IP address and Netmask provided by the ISP
- DHCP – Obtain the IP address automatically from the ISP.
- PPPoE – Configure the PPPoE username and password provided by the ISP.

The screenshot displays the FortiGate web interface for editing the 'port1' interface. The left sidebar shows the navigation menu with 'Network' > 'Interfaces' selected. The main panel is titled 'Edit Interface' and contains the following configuration fields:

- Name:** port1
- Alias:** WAN
- Type:** Physical Interface
- VRF ID:** 0
- Role:** WAN
- Estimated bandwidth:** 0 kbps Upstream, 0 kbps Downstream
- Addressing mode:** PPPoE (selected from Manual, DHCP, PPPoE)
- Username:** Username@ISP
- Password:** [Masked]
- Unnumbered IP:** 0.0.0.0
- Initial Disc Timeout:** 1
- Initial PADT Timeout:** 1
- Retrieve default gateway from server:** [Enabled]
- Distance:** 5
- Override internal DNS:** [Enabled]
- Administrative Access:**
 - IPv4: ☐ HTTPS, ☐ FMG-Access, ☐ FTM
 - ☐ HTTP, ☐ SSH, ☐ RADIUS Accounting
 - ☐ PING, ☐ SNMP, ☐ Security Fabric Connection

Step 3 - Configure Administrative Access

Enable the required administrative access services such as HTTPS, SSH, and PING according to your management requirements.

Best Practice: Allow administrative access from trusted networks only.

Step 4 - Configure the Default Gateway

Enable the option: “retrieve default gateway from server”.

Technical Notes

- Use Manual when the ISP provides a static public IP address.
- Use DHCP when the ISP automatically assigns an IP address.
- Use PPPoE when the ISP requires PPPoE authentication using a username and password.
- Enable only the administrative access protocols required in your environment.

Result

The WAN interface is configured successfully and is ready for Internet connectivity.